INTERPERSONAL FALSE BELIEF #20 · RELATIVES

“I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems.”

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Where it often comes from

In many families one person becomes the fixer: the capable one who steps in with money, advice, rescues, or mediation. Often it begins in childhood, when a parent was overwhelmed. Over time, the role becomes identity, and we feel guilty when we cannot solve a problem or when others do not accept our help.

What Scripture teaches

Paul says, “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ,” and in the same chapter, “each one should carry his own load.” Both are true: we help, and each person remains responsible for their life. “Each of us will give an account of himself to God.” Jesus said, “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest… My burden is light.” The Lord is the Savior of your family. You are not.

> *“For each one should carry his own load”* (Galatians 6:5).

Also see

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “So then, each of us will give an account of himself to God” (Romans 14:12).

> “Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light” (Matthew 11:28–30).

> “The soul who sins is the one who will die. A son will not bear the iniquity of his father, and a father will not bear the iniquity of his son. The righteousness of the righteous man will fall upon him, and the wickedness of the wicked man will fall upon him” (Ezekiel 18:20).

Common self-statements

- If I do not step in, everything will fall apart.
- They need me to fix this.
- I am the only responsible one.
- It is my fault if they struggle.
- I cannot rest until it is solved.
- Who else will do it?

Common logical errors

- Personalization: Treating others’ problems as my responsibility.
- Magnification: Believing everything depends on me.
- Should statements: Insisting that I should rescue everyone.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining collapse if I step back.

Challenging questions

- When did I become the fixer, and why?
- Which problems are really mine, and which belong to others?

- What happens when I rescue repeatedly?
- What is the difference between helping and rescuing?
- What does Jesus invite me to do with my burden?
- What is one problem I can hand back or hand to God?

Truth summary

> I can help my family without being their savior. Each person carries their own load, and I can carry burdens with them in healthy ways. I can rest in Jesus, who is gentle, and trust Him with what I cannot fix.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Servant
- Pride
- Trust
- Tired

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Communication

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Oh My Soul — Casting Crowns
Honest distress can coexist with faith and hope in God.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When did I become the fixer?
- ☐ Which problems are mine?
- ☐ What does rescuing cost?
- ☐ How can I help without fixing?
- ☐ What can I hand to God?
- ☐ Where can I rest?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Each person carries their own load.
- ☐ Helping is not the same as rescuing.
- ☐ Jesus gives me rest.
- ☐ I am not the Savior of my family.
- ☐ I can say no to some requests.
- ☐ God is able to work in their lives.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Galatians 6:5
  "For each one should carry his own load."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."
- ☐ Matthew 11:28–30
  "Come to Me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me; for I am gentle and humble in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. For My yoke is easy and My burden is light."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Handed back: Each week, write one problem you handed back to its owner or to God.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Galatians 6:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Each person carries their own load, and I can trust God with my family.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Tired" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ Sort the problems. List family problems and mark whose they are.
- ☐ Hand one back. Choose one problem to return kindly to its owner.
- ☐ Offer help differently. Offer listening or prayer instead of fixing.
- ☐ Rest in Matthew 11:28–30. Read it slowly and pray it.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A load handed back
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm responsible for fixing my family's problems.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, I have tried to carry my family. I give You the burdens I cannot fix. Teach me to help with wisdom, to hand back what is theirs, and to rest in You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.